

ENG523 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 01 to 05

(ENG523) Discourse Analysis

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

REGARDS : SIR ZAHID: 03342743020

Lecture-01

Introduction to Discourse Analysis

Topic: Introduction to Discourse Analysis

What is discourse analysis?

Discourse analysis is the study of the relationship between language and the contexts in which it is used.

Who are the key figures in British discourse analysis, and what were their contributions?

M. A. K. Halliday emphasized the social functions of language and thematic structure.

Sinclair and Coulthard developed a model for analyzing teacher-pupil talk.

British discourse analysis focused on structural-linguistic criteria and units.

What were the main contributions of British discourse analysis to the field?

British Discourse Analysis: British discourse analysis was influenced by M. A. K. Halliday's functional approach, emphasizing social functions of language and thematic structures. Additionally, work by Sinclair and Coulthard focused on the analysis of teacher-pupil talk and hierarchy of discourse units.

How does American discourse analysis differ from the British tradition?

American Discourse Analysis: American discourse analysis, particularly ethnomethodological tradition, involves close observation of communication in natural settings. It focuses on various speech events, including storytelling and greeting rituals. This approach emphasizes the social nature of communication and conversational norms.

What is the distinction between form and function in discourse analysis?

Form and Function: Discourse analysis involves understanding not only the structural aspects but also the functions of language. Form refers to the surface-level characteristics, while function focuses on the specific purpose and meaning behind language use.

What characterizes American discourse analysis, and which traditions influence it?

American discourse analysis is influenced by ethnomethodological tradition. It emphasizes close observation of people communicating in natural settings.

What are some types of speech events often analyzed in American discourse analysis?

Storytelling, greeting rituals, verbal duels, and various cultural and social settings.

What is the role of cohesion in discourse analysis?

Cohesion involves the use of linguistic cues to create links and relationships between different parts of a text.

What is the distinction between text, discourse, and context in analyzing discourse?

Text refers to the verbal and non-verbal elements used in communication.

Discourse involves hierarchically structured acts carried out to achieve a communicative goal.

Context is the background and situational factors that affect communication.

How does cohesion contribute to text coherence?

Cohesion provides cues for the reader to create coherence but does not guarantee it.

How can larger patterns in text, such as problem-solution structures, be identified and analyzed in discourse?

Larger Text Patterns: Larger patterns in text, like problem-solution structures, are common and are identified through grammatical and lexical devices. Recognizing these patterns is important for text interpretation and composition.

What is the essence of discourse analysis, and why has it gained importance in linguistics and other disciplines?

Essence of Discourse Analysis: Discourse analysis focuses on the study of language in context, emphasizing how language is used and its relationship with broader contexts. It has become a critical area of study in linguistics and various other disciplines.

Who were some influential figures in the development of discourse analysis?

Zellig Harris, M. A. K. Halliday, Sinclair and Coulthard, and Michael Hoey contributed to the development of discourse analysis.

What is a common pattern found in many texts and what is it called?

The problem-solution pattern, where a situation is presented, followed by a complication or problem, a response to the problem, and a positive evaluation of the response.

How do grammatical and lexical devices play a role in signaling larger patterns in text?

Conjunctions, backward lexical references, and forward references are used to signal and structure larger patterns in text.

Lecture-02

Two Strands of Discourse Analysis

Topic: Spoken Language-I

What are some different types of speech in people's everyday lives?

Telephone calls, interviews, classroom discussions, rituals, monologues, casual conversation, organizing and directing people.

What are adjacency pairs in conversation?

Adjacency pairs are units of conversation where two speakers exchange one turn each, and the first turn requires a specific type of response.

Give an example of an adjacency pair.

Answer: Greeting (hello) - Response (hello).

What is the significance of softeners in conversation?

Softeners like "I'm afraid" are used to preface disagreement second pair-parts in English, especially in friendly situations.

How is turn-taking managed in conversation?

Turn-taking is managed through various means, including formal methods, adjacency pairs, intonation, gestures, and changes in gaze direction.

Topic: Spoken Language-II

What is the difference between transactional and interactional talk?

Transactional talk focuses on accomplishing tasks, while interactional talk focuses on building and maintaining relationships.

Give examples of talk as transaction.

Classroom group discussions, ordering food in a restaurant, making a phone call for information, etc.

What is the purpose of small talk in interactional talk?

Small talk is used to create a positive atmosphere and establish comfort between people, often in social situations.

What are the skills involved in managing conversation topics?

Initiating topics, selecting appropriate vocabulary, giving feedback responses, taking turns, and using discourse strategies for repair and closure.

What are the main skills involved in using English for transactions?

Selecting relevant vocabulary, using communication strategies, asking and answering questions, and clarifying information.

Topic: Idea Theory of Meaning

What is an anecdote in the context of written discourse?

An anecdote is a very short story that adds personal knowledge or experience to a topic.

Give an example of a philosophical anecdote.

An anecdote told to make others think more deeply about a topic.

Why are anecdotes valuable literary devices?

Anecdotes add diversity in style, tone, and utility to stories and make situations more interesting for both the characters and the audience.

Topic: Written Language-I

What is the notion of text type in written discourse?

Text type is an abstract category characterizing the main structure of a text based on its dominant properties, such as narrative or description.

Differentiate between text type and genre.

Text type characterizes the structure of texts, while genre refers to specific categories of texts with historical and contextual variations.

Topic: Units in Written Discourse

What is the role of the sentence in written discourse?

Sentences are grammatical and orthographic units that can be part of functional segments in written discourse.

How can text coherence be achieved in segment-chain activities?

By arranging segments in a logical sequence of clause relations and making any necessary changes for coherence.

Topic: Patterns and the Learner

What is the significance of learning patterns in various fields of study?

Learning patterns were originally developed to support university students, but they can be applied to learners in different situations like engineering, business, science, and everyday life. This is possible due to the abstract descriptions of pattern language, which can be adapted for diverse learning needs.

How does written text conform to certain patterns in discourse analysis?

Written text naturally follows specific patterns and conforms to rules that successful writers unconsciously follow. Some of the characteristic patterns include the Problem/Solution structure, Claim/Counterclaim structure, and General/Specific structure.

What are the common textual patterns reported in studies?

Predominant studies have reported three common patterns: problem-solution, claim-counterclaim, and general-specific. The problem-solution pattern includes situation, problem, response, and evaluation. The claim-counterclaim pattern involves presenting a series of claims and contrasting counterclaims, while the general-specific pattern comprises a generalization followed by more specific statements.

How do discourse-organizing words contribute to these patterns?

Discourse-organizing words, specific to each pattern, help organize and structure written text. For instance, signaling words are essential for the problem-solution, claim-counterclaim, and general-specific patterns, as reported in studies.

Topic: Culture and Rhetoric

What is culture, and how does it influence human behavior?

Culture is a system of beliefs, values, and assumptions shared by a group of people. It includes customs, language, and material artifacts. Culture guides behavior and is transmitted from generation to generation without explicit instruction.

What is rhetoric, and how does it relate to culture?

Rhetoric is the art, practice, and study of human communication. The convergence of rhetoric, culture, and communication has led to the development of intercultural rhetoric and comparative rhetoric, where culture-based arguments and rhetorical traditions are studied.

What does intercultural rhetoric focus on, and how is it related to communication?

Intercultural rhetoric studies how culture-based arguments are constructed during intercultural interactions. Rhetorical practices emerge from the beliefs and values of cultural communities. It reveals how diverse cultural assumptions become apparent during intercultural interactions.

What is the focus of comparative rhetoric, and how does it differ from intercultural rhetoric?

Comparative rhetoric focuses on the cross-cultural study of rhetorical traditions in various societies, past or present. Unlike intercultural rhetoric, it doesn't involve interaction but rather a comparison of rhetorical practices in different cultures.

Topic: Discourse and the Reader

How do reading pedagogy approaches vary between bottom-up and top-down strategies?

The debate centers on whether bottom-up (textual decoding from small elements) or top-down (using macro-level clues) reading strategies are more important. The current consensus leans toward a compromise between local and global decoding, using both approaches simultaneously.

How does cohesion relate to coherent interpretation in reading?

The relationship between cohesion and coherence is complex. Focusing solely on cohesive devices may not guarantee a coherent interpretation of the text. Cohesion's role in reading needs to be balanced with other factors.

What is the role of schema theory in reading, and how does it work?

Schema theory suggests that new knowledge is processed coherently when related to existing knowledge frameworks. These frameworks include knowledge about the world and how texts are typically structured and organized, referred to as content and formal schemata.

What is the teacher's role in relation to schema theory in reading?

The teacher's role is to help readers activate the appropriate schemata, both content and formal, for various textual encounters. However, it's not certain whether activating formal schemata alone can help if content schemata are lacking.

How do readers engage with text, and what role does prediction play?

Readers actively attend to discourse segmentation through intonational features, orthographical features, and lexicogrammatical signals. Good readers are constantly predicting what's to come, both in terms of content and larger patterns, by interpreting the author's signals at the grammar and vocabulary levels.

Lecture-03

Discourse Markers and Conversation

Discourse Markers

What are discourse markers, and how do they function in language?

Discourse markers are expressions that serve various functions in language.

List some examples of discourse markers.

Examples include "oh," "well," "y'know," and "but."

According to Laurel J. Brinton, what are some functions of discourse markers?

Discourse markers are used to initiate discourse, mark boundaries, preface responses, serve as fillers, hold the floor, affect interactions, and bracket discourse.

How did Schiffrin's analysis of discourse markers aim to reconcile linguistics and sociology?

Schiffrin's analysis aimed to account for the distribution of markers in spoken discourse while considering both language form and social interaction.

What is the main objective of understanding discourse markers in the context of communication?

Understanding discourse markers helps in interpreting communication, distinguishing subtext, and analyzing the social aspects of language use.

Can you provide some examples of discourse markers, and explain how they function in conversation?

Examples of discourse markers include words like "oh," "well," "y'know," and "but." These markers can initiate discourse, mark shifts in topics, preface responses, serve as fillers, aid in holding the floor in a conversation, influence the interaction between

speakers and listeners, and help bracket the discourse by marking foregrounded or backgrounded information.

Context in Discourse

What is linguistic context, and how does it relate to discourse analysis?

Linguistic context refers to the relationship between words, phrases, and sentences in discourse, aiding in understanding meaning.

Define situational context and discuss its role in communication.

Situational context encompasses the environment, time, place, and participant relationships, influencing how discourse unfolds.

What does cultural context refer to, and how does it affect language use?

Cultural context relates to the culture, customs, and background of language communities, influencing social roles, status, and addressing based on sex and age.

How is context in discourse analysis divided into different dimensions?

Context is divided into linguistic context, situational context, and cultural context.

How does cultural context affect language use in discourse, and why is it significant?

Cultural context refers to the influence of culture, customs, social roles, status, and demographics on language use within a specific community. It is essential in understanding language and communication as it can impact how speakers address each other, the words and expressions they use, and the social dynamics within discourse.

Conversation Analysis

What is the primary focus of conversation analysis (CA)?

CA primarily focuses on the organization of human social interaction, including spoken discourse.

Who were the key figures in the development of conversation analysis?

Harvey Sacks, Emanuel A. Schegloff, and Gail Jefferson were key figures in the development of CA.

How does conversation analysis typically involve the analysis of talk?

CA involves the analysis of spoken data and the examination of sequences, turn-taking, preferences, feedback, repair, openings, closings, and other elements of talk.

What are some transcription conventions used in conversation analysis?

Transcription conventions include symbols for indicating overlap, non-speech intervals, stress, volume, intonation, and other aspects of talk.

How has conversation analysis been applied to second language conversation and pedagogy?

CA has been used to analyze non-native speaker talk and to understand the acquisition of a second language, as well as to enhance language teaching and learning.

How does conversation analysis typically involve the analysis of talk, and what is its approach to studying language?

Conversation analysis involves the analysis of spoken data, examining aspects like sequences of utterances, turn-taking, preferences, feedback, and other elements of talk. It approaches language as a dynamic tool for social interaction, focusing on how speakers use language in real-life conversations.

Can you explain some of the transcription conventions used in conversation analysis and their significance in studying spoken discourse?

Transcription conventions in conversation analysis include symbols for indicating overlap, non-speech intervals, stress, volume, intonation, and other aspects of talk. These conventions are essential for accurately representing and analyzing spoken language data, allowing researchers to capture the nuances of spoken discourse.

Lecture-04

Discourse and Sociolinguistics

Topic 1: Discourse and Sociolinguistics

What is a discourse community?

A Discourse community is a group of people who share common goals, communication mechanisms, terminology, and expertise in a particular field.

What are the characteristics of a discourse community, according to Swales?

Swales' characteristics for a discourse community include shared goals, communication methods, specialized terminology, and expertise in a specific area.

How do discourse communities interact with speech communities?

Discourse communities interact with wider speech communities, and the way people communicate within them can vary based on the group's characteristics.

What is the difference between a discourse community and a speech community?

A discourse community is a more specialized group with shared goals and expertise, whereas a speech community refers to a broader group of people who speak the same language.

What factors can affect language choice in discourse and communication?

Social factors, such as the context, audience, topic, and formality, can influence language choice during communication.

Discourse Ideology

How are ideologies defined in the context of social cognition and discourse?

Answer: Ideologies are defined as a form of social cognition shared by social groups, shaping their beliefs and practices, including discourse.

What is the relationship between ideologies and the mental representations of individuals?

Ideologies influence the underlying mental processes involved in discourse and other social practices, but the internal structures of these mental representations are still not fully understood.

What distinguishes group knowledge from other beliefs in the context of ideologies?

Group knowledge tends to be presupposed by its members and is not asserted in text and talk, making it a potential basis for ideological beliefs.

What is "Cultural Common Ground" in the context of ideologies?

Cultural Common Ground refers to beliefs generally shared in society, serving as the basis of common sense, and not subject to ideological struggles.

Language Ideologies

How do language ideologies and language attitudes contribute to our understanding of linguistic subjectivity?

Both concepts help incorporate speakers' feelings and ideas about language into research on language change, identity, and socioeconomic context.

What are the differences in methodology between studying language attitudes and language ideologies?

Language attitudes are often associated with quantitative measurement, while language ideologies are studied using qualitative methods like ethnography and discourse analysis.

What is the role of language ideologies in nation-building projects?

Language ideologies are often recruited in nation-building efforts, where they shape beliefs and practices related to the nation-state, ethnic minorities, and language use.

How do powerful institutional domains like law and education contribute to the development of language ideologies?

These domains generate language ideologies, particularly within the framework of nation-states, as they function within specific nation-state conditions.

Speech Community Identities

What is a speech community in sociolinguistics and linguistic anthropology?

A speech community is a group of people who share the same language, speech characteristics, and ways of interpreting communication.

How do speech communities help individuals define themselves?

Speech communities help individuals define themselves as individuals and community members and identify others.

What are some examples of speech communities in terms of size?

Speech communities can range from large regions with distinct accents to small groups like families and friends.

How do speech communities play a role in various social sciences?

Speech communities are relevant in sociology, anthropology, linguistics, psychology, migration studies, and ethnic identity studies.

According to Zdenek Salzmann, what criteria should define a speech community?

Speech communities should be defined based on characteristics such as pronunciation, grammar, vocabulary, and manner of speaking.

Nation-State Identities

What is national identity in the context of the nation-state?

National identity is a person's sense of belonging to a nation, marked by traditions, culture, language, and politics.

What is the ideal of a "nation-state"?

The ideal of a nation-state is one where a single ethnic stock and cultural traditions dominate, with cultural boundaries matching political boundaries.

How did the concept of the "nation-state" develop over time?

The concept of the nation-state emerged in the nineteenth century and became the political community representing all citizens.

What are some contemporary challenges to the concept of the nation-state?

Most contemporary states are polyethnic, and the connection between identity and locale has been severed due to globalization and transnational movements.

Multicultural Identities

How do multicultural individuals navigate their cultural identities?

Multicultural individuals manage and organize their diverse cultural identities within their overall sense of self.

What characterized the theorization of identity in the 1990s?

The 1990s saw a shift in understanding identity as performative and discursive, challenging static notions of selfhood.

How did developments like multiculturalism and postmodernism influence the study of identity?

Postmodern challenges to the authoritative voice of the analyst and the rise of digital communication influenced a shift in understanding identity as discursive and multiple.

Social Languages, Conversations, and Intertextuality

What are social languages, and how do they relate to social identity?

Social languages are linguistic varieties used based on social identity in different settings, influencing word choices and sentence structure.

How do social languages differ from Discourses?

Social languages refer to the role of language in Discourses, which encompass more than just language, including actions, values, and beliefs.

What are the four types of conversations based on direction and tone?

The four types of conversations are debate, dialogue, discourse, and diatribe, each with different purposes and tones.

How can you identify intertextuality in a text, and why is it important?

Intertextuality involves quoting or alluding to other texts. It's important to understand how it influences a person's interpretation of a text and their understanding of its meaning.

Lecture-05

Discourse and Speech

Introduction to Speech Acts

What is the speech act theory's main premise?

Speech act theory views language as a form of action rather than a mere medium for expressing thoughts.

Who developed the contemporary speech act theory, and when was it introduced?

J. L. Austin, a British philosopher of language, introduced the contemporary speech act theory in 1975.

What did J. L. Austin's findings reveal about language usage?

Austin's findings showed that people use language not just to assert things but also to perform actions.

Types of Speech Acts

What are constative utterances, and how do they function?

Constative utterances describe or denote situations and can be evaluated as true or false statements.

How do performative utterances differ from constative ones?

Performative utterances do not describe anything but express the speaker's feelings, attitudes, emotions, and thoughts.

Name and explain the three categories into which speech acts are divided.

Locutionary act: The act of saying something with a specific meaning.

Illocutionary act: An act performed by saying something, which carries a certain force, tone, or intention.

Perlocutionary act: Acts that create effects or consequences in the audience, such as thoughts, emotions, or imaginations.

Speech Acts and Discourse Analysis

How does speech act theory consider language as an instrument for communication?

Speech act theory views language as a means of performing social acts, with speech acts as the basic units of communication.

Why is context important in understanding speech acts in discourse?

Context is crucial because it helps extract meaning from surrounding context through the conventionalization of illocutionary usages.

Politeness, Face, and Discourse

What is the concept of 'face' in the context of politeness?

'Face' refers to a person's social identity and need to maintain both involvement and independence in social interactions.

How do politeness principles and cooperative principles sometimes conflict with each other?

Politeness and cooperative principles may conflict based on the social distance, power dynamics, significance of the request, and cultural context.

Face-threatening Acts

What are face-threatening acts, and how are they managed in communication?

Face-threatening acts are acts that threaten a person's social identity or face, and they can be mitigated using various communication strategies like pre-sequences or off-record speech acts.

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